

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Sairdron strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept

12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** Committed by Alex; Sept 13-14 light daily catch-ups held flat with nothing new clearing the sufficiency bar, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 16 (score set 2026-09-16_draft):** RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12/36mo windows to 1/1/14/33/66 (from 1/1/18/38/70) — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council, and 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a Sept 12-13 statement calling for NPT withdrawal, with a hardline MP describing an emergency bill being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News); Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons stance and the Foreign Ministry's "still being prepared" framing kept the move modest. AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **THIS VERSION (Sept 17, score set 2026-09-17_draft) HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66** — re-checked, no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's and the Foreign Ministry's positions are unchanged. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **Sept 18 (score set 2026-09-18_draft, this version) HOLDS FLAT again at 1/1/14/33/66.** Two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders — dated and multi-sourced (Axios original, corroborated by Times of Israel, Politico Wire, Breitbart, RedState, Western Journal, anews — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty, so it does not clear the bar for a further move. Separately, an initial general search surfaced a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 18; a follow-up targeted search could not independently corroborate this from any named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source — **treated as NOT FIRED / NOT USED** per this report's house discipline for uncorroborated single claims. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (Sept 19, score set 2026-09-19_draft) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-09-18_draft) — independent primary-source research across all five windows found nothing that clears the sufficiency bar for a move. Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging the legal Article X process, Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done, and a bill was submitted for expedited consideration — but Iran's own Foreign Ministry still calls it "in preparation," so this remains a proposal, not a completed act (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated, the same treatment this pillar has always given Iranian-sourced claims). Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman) — very well corroborated (Axios, Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News, 5+ independent), but still rhetoric about an undated future decision; **the Sept 22 meeting itself is now flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.** The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel, Russia and China dissenting (Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) — a primary UN press release (press.un.org, sc16455 and related), corroborated by Euronews and Security Council Report — institutional gridlock over the 2025 snapback dispute, not a new sanction or act of war. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18) this pillar could not corroborate last cycle is now CONFIRMED via the IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org) plus independent outlets including The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, and Rio Times — reversing last cycle's NOT FIRED call, but it is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P. Brent settled ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (CNBC, Al Jazeera), down 1.5% day-over-day but still near the multi-month highs reached in early September — a market price, not scored. Iran has now gone nine straight days without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, fragile de-escalatory data point — while a Houthis-linked air-raid alert hit Riyadh Sept 19 for the first time since July (Times of Israel liveblog) — a mixed signal on the proxy front; neither clears the bar alone. FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified the Oman understanding will NOT by itself reopen Hormuz, conditioned on the US honoring the 60-day Islamabad MOU (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa) — a net wash. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66 — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.** See My Decision below.

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 18, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-18_draft (P **HELD FLAT** at 1/1/14/33/66). Trump's Sept 17 Axios "big decision"/"annihilate" re
tanker named "Trend" could NOT be independently corroborated on a follow-up targeted search and was NOT FIRED / NOT USED. · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · Prior set: Sept 18 light daily touch (2
Iran's parliament continues moving toward but has NOT enacted NPT withdrawal (still "in preparation" per its own Foreign Ministry) — a proposal, not a completed act. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces
near-term trigger to watch next cycle. The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining, Sept 17) to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional
reversing last cycle's "not fired" call — but it's a continuation of an already-active tanker campaign, not new escalation, so it updates the record without moving P. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categori
Updated & Re-verified September 22, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-22_draft: carried forward unchanged at 1/1/14/33/66 — not re-researched this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down ins
Financial Advice

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITTED)
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	1
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	3
3 years	85	...	76	75	75	74	74	73	73	72	72	71	7

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 14, LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15_draft): RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from the Sept 13-committed 3/3/18/38/70) — “The GCC has been decided to postpone to a later date the regional meeting that was to be held on Monday in Salalah, in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue.” **No new date was set** — not the scheduling: **Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending, no GCC state had confirmed participation, and the UAE had already downgraded to a minister of state** rather than its foreign minister. **Iranian officials, reported here but not relied on to move P.** A second dated fact caps the upside of what does survive: FM Araqchi said Sept 13 that the Iran-Oman understanding “would be a positive position; echoed Sept 14 by Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian). Market reaction, reported as a *market price* and not an estimate: Brent past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November)** and WTI past **\$100/bbl (+2.8%, \$100.54 November)** — **1, 3 and 11, 2026**, not September, and are NOT treated as new. Windows: 1mo 3–1, 3mo 3–1, 6mo 19–18, 12mo 39–38 (held one point above the Sept 12 level — the Iran-Oman bilateral I

Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70 (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four para fact beyond that morning baseline (which already covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and the Sept 10 UKMTO Warning 133-26 near Khasab): **Saudi Arabia's East-V (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11)**, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs request while reserving the right to act later; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing and closed the Shalameh/Iraq-Iran border crossing as a precaution — corroborating, semi-primary. **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility; President Trump (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire — Iraq has been an active the fire — no confirmed US military casualty found this cycle. The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (Brent ~\$104.61 Sept 12, the same level as the morning baseline) — persistence want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, consistent with (not additive to) the already-logged MBS-twice-refused-strikes restraint counterweight; the BRICS New "exercising maximum restraint," and expressing concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, diplomatic, long-horizon data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The M Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge); no new UKMTO warning was found beyond the already-logged Warning 133-26. **Sizing:** a third distinct attack on Saudi oil infrastructure this week modest further move given the persistent-pattern read — but it is a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty, so sized small: 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat (a held at the near-floor 1 — no further room reasoned. **This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of move size — LEFT**

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily, score set 2026-09-12, draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70 (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40/71). **BEARISH and NEW: a second glob**
10 baseline as "closing in" on Bab al-Mandeb), continued an offensive that by Sept 11 captured Dhubab and Murad — the final coastal towns held by the internationally recognized Yemeni go
the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island. This is confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald) and is
distinct from Hormuz, not merely an approach to one. Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence,
Yemen/the Houthis are an existing theater (not a further NEW state), so the widening clause does not independently fire; no US casualty is claimed or confirmed, so that clause does not fire ei
cycles), not a fresh flip-line event. **BEARISH and NEW, second fact:** UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10, the UK's official maritime security authority — primary source) c
News, Maritime Executive, The Hill). **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-source):** IREGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near t
TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the flip-line clause that already fired Sept 10-11, not a fresh trigger. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo**
strike grind of the past week, sized moderately larger than recent 1-point touches but still restrained since no flip-line newly fires — the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar (UKM
AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."

Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71 (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW — a second, distinct** fire but did not cleanly fire, now fires on a third consecutive session: Brent **ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107** after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four years (the NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. *Correction to the prior cycle:* that cycle, run mid-morning, was **fact:** fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz, 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers, the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since 2011, *not* a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause still does NOT fire; no strike on a further new state was confirmed, so the widening clause does not fire either. **Logged but not stamped.** **Counterweight, also logged:** Friday's give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around Hormuz plus the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast — the market is not a pillar's own flip line firing is a real escalation of its evidence standard — but under the runbook's widened delegated authority the size of a move is not itself a reason to withhold the stamp; the stamp is **stamped).**"

Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72 (from the Sept 9-committed 1/6/23/43/72). Two new dated facts. **BEARISH and NEW:** C — Jordan's armed forces say 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGPlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is confirmed-US-casualty clause also does NOT fire (DCAS remains 18, unchanged since Sept 4 — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as unconfirmed). **Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait** — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Theater already priced, not a strike on a further new state, and no strait closure or shipping interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threatening" the strait). **Oil** — \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's singling out of the flip line and worth close watching next cycle, but it does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation. **Score** — **3mo 6–5, 6mo 23–22, 12mo 43–42, 36mo held at 72** (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move the multi-year thesis). No window moved more than 1 point. **Outlook** — Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRCG targeted a US Navy warship** in addition to CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualties bar. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries"). Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement (already logged in the Sept 8 bar) does not independently fire that clause either; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line. Iran's Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event, sized consistently with those cycles' modest per-cycle price moves. No touch, no window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral).

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS** new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list. He separately said an Iranian ship had been seized (see [Reuters](#), [Newsbytes](#), [WFLA/Nexstar](#), [GlobalSecurity.org](#)) reporting the same on-record statement — clearing the sufficiency bar. It is a genuine new escalatory signal, but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet a THREAT OF ACTION. It has not yet actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. Consistent with this pillar's past treatment of confirmed-but-not-yet-executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing options" on Iran, which was not scored separately, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 ([tradingeconomics.com](#)) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade could be a new state, but it is not yet clear. It is not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed (still "in the coming days" per Rezaei; the existing temporary 7-mile corridor from late August remains the open option, but it is not yet clear if it will be expanded or if a new shipping-zone threat doesn't move the multi-year thesis). This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the message is clear. **STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). BEARISH about CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) states US forces struck THREE Iranian cruise missiles destroyed in the Gulf of Oman — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded multiple attacks, "inflicting no economic cost — taking out three of yours." This clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly withheld on (it had only Iran's Tasnim state-media claim, with AP framing it as an accusation of INTENTION: a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels. Separately, Sept 6 (today) IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a U.S. ship. NOT independently used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: no confirmed new US combat death (DCAS still 18 as of Sept 4, unchanged from Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. The cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line. Not more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's deletion rule.

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED, the load-bearing new fact: the conflict escalated materially** — IIRC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, communications sites, and anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike (much less than the **US** reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy, a marked shift from the prior posture of intercepting attacks. Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1 — its best session in 5 weeks — to ~\$95-96. Hormozgan governor's office named 4 of at least 5 dead, including a 4-year-old, plus 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI). **Flagged EXPLICITLY AS SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCE** by the **US** neither confirmed nor denied it — so per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does not move P, even though multiple Western outlets report the claim (wide pickup of a single-narrative core from the **US** drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously — Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait — a materially larger, four-country retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike of Aug 30, 2026 (see Feb-Jul 2026 per this war's own tracker pages), so the pillar's own "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire. Most projectiles were intercepted by the **US** US combat death has been found as of this run — so neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes

larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military source told press Tehran's response would be "massive" — the threshold: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. **Originally left as draft Sept 2, not auto-stamped, for three reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty fact — the emotional weight of the event is greater than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event; (2) the scale jump (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is a genuinely novel escalation beyond this pillar's prior single-incident sizing; (3) the FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set, which under the then-current rules disqualified auto-stamp on its own. **On September 3, 2026, Aleph** — the underlying sourcing and sufficiency-rule handling are unchanged — the wedding-casualty claim still was not used to move P — only the stamping threshold changed. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **BEARISH** assumption that "one resumed-strike night is not yet a sustained new campaign" — that assumption is undercut by what happened next. A THIRD Hormuz tanker was hit Aug 31: the Liberian-registered *Al-Salam* (side, engine room, and ballast tank; no casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents. *Al-Salam* was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran — a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border strike as a repeat target (already struck Jul 28), not a "further new" state per this pillar's own framing. President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran, calling it "a real possibility" (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports) on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle of gains on this news thread. No new confirmation of "confirmed new US combat death" clause nor a clean "further new state struck" clause fires cleanly. This is a continuation/erosion of the "single incident" framing, not a fresh shock of comparison. 36mo 75→75 (flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International, and UKMTO. Prior to this, on Aug 30 US forces shot down a Iranian jet. Spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins confirmed on the record, corroborated by 20+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, etc.) — a ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line ("a resumption of direct strikes on Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given) and retaliated hours later, into Aug 31, with ballistic missiles at two US-linked airbases in Jordan (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — an interception, so logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. That cut was front-loaded and held under 8 points per window, sized similarly to the Jul 28 Jordan-strike precedent for a comparable event. 14/22/38/54/76 on a genuinely two-sided ledger: **BEARISH and CONFIRMED: the "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24.** Directly fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release on recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client commentary (EO 13902). Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this program — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed as directly crypto-relevant — a genuine escalation. It continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation. Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents fired this window: Aug 27 and Aug 28 — an already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): "The war began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as continuation/intensification of an existing pattern of hostilities (casualties/workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry statement, Aug 26.** In every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor. "Joint Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were announced by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. Trump declared the Strait "demined" with a zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, etc.). Brent +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 thru the Strait during the whole crisis. Brent eased for a SECOND straight week: ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line was not confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset.** The pillar's own explicit upside flip line — a signed, US-accepted Hormuz deal holding — was not confirmed. Iran+Oman only (not US-accepted). Consistent with this pillar's standing discipline against chasing single-cycle mixed signals in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petrolina pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus a secondary "probably Iran" attribution is explicitly NOT used to move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint seizure — remains corroborated across 6+ independent outlets. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged this cycle per house rules: 0.60/0.65/0.70/0.65/0.55 for 1/3/6/12/36mo.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 12. The pillar's adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the real, visible risk-off pullback logged when this pillar's own

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 16, 2026 (light daily touch, P re-rated down on the 6/12/36mo windows as the nuclear track escalates alongside the shooting war)

This cycle (Sept 16): the crowd's attention today is almost entirely on the CLARITY Act vote failure, not Iran — but two real, dated escalatory facts landed this week on the nuclear track that this pillar is tracking: the withdrawal on Sept 12-13. **Me:** I'm treating this as real but bounded — a parliamentary push and an institutional referral are documented facts, not a completed NPT exit, and Pezeshkian's own public statement on the 6/12/36mo windows (18→14, 38→33, 70→66) and not on 1mo/3mo, which were already sitting at this pillar's floor of 1 with no room left to express further deterioration. The shooting-war track is allowed to independently move anything.

Prior cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petrolina pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss it as a drone strike launched from Iraqi soil hit a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a refinery this time) for the third time this week, and that pattern — accordingly: the move is small (3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each) precisely because the load-bearing fact is a single infrastructure strike with no widening (Iraq is already an active theater since the Sept 11 attack on its own account of Houthi reluctance to draw in the US are both logged honestly as counterweights, because a system that only reports escalation isn't honest either.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" background noise. The aligned forces now hold actual chokepoint-controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one, and that upgrades the standing risk even though no clause in this pillar's flip-line event while still stopping short of treating it as a flip-line event, because it isn't one by this pillar's own pre-declared, falsifiable definitions — and I'd rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than the other way: the US is not chasing every escalation into a wider war.

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave that off and three consecutive sessions above it, including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles when it hadn't fired yet; the discipline only counts if it actually fires, not a state, and the one death in the Sept 9 shipping wave was a merchant seafarer, not a service member. So this is a further modest cut, not a regime change — and the give-back on diplomacy headlines is a

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise to the main event. It absorbed this kind of strike repeatedly since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time either — a repeat-pattern event, not a new category. The Houthi escalation has been months, so it doesn't independently widen the war, but "closing in on" a second global chokepoint is a genuine structural development worth flagging even though no blockade has actually been declared. The signal yet that markets are pricing this as durable rather than a one-day spike. Re-rating down modestly again (1/5/22/42/72, from 1/6/23/43/72), consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" rather than a new line, but it is explicitly not the same thing as a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires — so it does not independently fire that clause, though it does fire the 5-tanker strike this pillar priced on Sept 6, but it is the same repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island) responding to the same kind of provocation (an IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship) — the pillar's sharp, consistent with the Sept 6 and Sept 8 cuts.

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new strategic corridor. It logged and worth a small cut, but it is not yet an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed incident tied to it as of this cycle's research cutoff. Re-rating down modestly (\$100) and it is consistent with — not a departure from — this pillar's past treatment of announced-but-unexecuted escalatory statements. I am explicitly not treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iranian ship was discounted for weeks.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that the US Navy warships that the US answered by destroying three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fired. The "resumption of direct US strikes" trajectory already priced in since Aug 30, not a new category of event. Sept 6's separate IRGC claims of further tanker/vessel/drone strikes were explicitly not used to move P. The pillar's earned.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing as a first-ever direct tanker strikes) is independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real story this cycle.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, stated plainly: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced at the level that matters (Iranian state-sourced primary event, and I don't want to self-approve a cut this large resting partly on that; (2) the scale jump — ~50x the Aug 30 strike, plus the war's first direct tanker strikes — is a genuinely magnitude of event is exactly the kind of judgment call the runbook says shouldn't be quietly self-approved; (3) both sides are now on-record threatening much larger responses ahead — a misc and the four-country retaliation does NOT independently fire the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause because all four targets are repeats.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation, mutual escalation threats) support on their own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to size around it instead.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp comparison itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of September 19, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-19_draft). Hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from this cycle appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.

- ★ ★ **NEW — the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) on Sept 18, 2026 to renew the panel of independent experts monitoring** reimposition — institutional gridlock, not a new fact on the ground, so it doesn't move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Trump told Axios (Sept 17, 2026) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a planned Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly** siding with Israel (Axios, Wire, Israel National News, Breitbart — 5+ independent). Rhetoric about an undated future decision, not an action — this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.
- ★ ★ **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle's "not fired" call:** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18, 2026 is now confirmed via the IRGC's own report or denial found. A continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign, not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council.** A primary institutional action by the IAEA itself, escalating international pressure.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for Iran's withdrawal from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty.** Times, and Mehr News — 3 independent outlets, though two are Iranian state-affiliated, so treated as corroborated reporting of a documented parliamentary act rather than independent Western news.
- **Counterweight, same sourcing set:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons, even as the parliamentary push proceeds. Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Qaeni said the same step, not a completed NPT exit.
- **Nothing new found** on the Salalah Iran-GCC ministerial (still postponed, no new date), the Saudi East-West pipeline (still offline), or Hormuz shipping beyond what the Sept 15 baseline already covered.

Carried forward from the September 12 full weekly refresh and the daily touches since — still load-bearing, not contradicted:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi MOC confirmed).** Pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of London, Reuters, Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing as a precaution.
- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Presumably, the US is not involved.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US casualties).
- **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, corroborated by Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE called for "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr+).
- **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, Zenger News).

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize Mocha.** Actual island-level control (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen is existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support of the US position.
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf News).
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation.
- **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" flip-line clause.
- **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** (CNBC). The week despite a ~3% give-back (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent). Three consecutive sessions above \$100, two intraday read, not the close.
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of ships** (Reuters, 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire.
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vessels.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 demand.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike** (CENTCOM's own military statement) — clears the sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a SECOND global shipping chokepoint (Reuters, Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on," not as having executed a blockade.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session,** more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9) but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS remains silent (statement).
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run.py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Dabir** (Reuters, 5 independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Ship").
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as US strikes Iranian oil tankers"). The "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to it.
- **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.

- ★ **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would be 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficient threshold for a **newly confirmed** event.
- ★ **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an Iranian state media outlet "will not be the first to report the details of the zone."
- ★ **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-priced event.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld previously** (Iranian state media reported a strike on a tanker in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded multiple attacks with no AFRS confirmation.
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels and a US Navy warship — taking out three of yours."
- ★ **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cycle.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and a US Navy warship (UPI).
- ★ **★ NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy** — confirmed by multiple sources.
- ★ **★ NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ **★ NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's office separately confirmed the strike, but CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities — wide Western-outlet pickup of that one narrative is not the same as a confirmed event.
- ★ **★ NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** — confirmed by multiple sources. This war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT apply.
- ★ **NEW — most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US strikes.
- ★ **NEW — both sides now on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened further strikes.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles (one confirmed, two suspected) — impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents — the third such hit in the same window.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incident** — separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran. So: a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone strike.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran**, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicit confirmation of a **newly confirmed** event.
- ★ **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle.
- ★ **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31**, but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — confirmed by multiple sources.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers (confirmed by Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, and Time. The event was **confirmed** by multiple sources, a **newly confirmed** event. ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two airbases, confirmed by multiple sources. Infrastructure, unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception — logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded.
- ★ **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures**, reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iran's Sanctionable Sector") and related materials (independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, and elsewhere) — confirmed by multiple sources. The event was **confirmed** by multiple sources, a **newly confirmed** event. "promised but not landed" sanctions rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and scored as fact.
- ★ **★ NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the event was **confirmed** by multiple sources, a **newly confirmed** event. "promised but not landed" sanctions rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and scored as fact. Terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal is single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded.
- ★ **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO).
- ★ **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian vessels from the Strait of Hormuz. The event was **confirmed** by multiple sources, a **newly confirmed** event. US forces cleared Iranian vessels from the Strait of Hormuz. The event was **confirmed** by multiple sources, a **newly confirmed** event. ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing pillar.
- ★ **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the event was **confirmed** by multiple sources, a **newly confirmed** event.
- ★ **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- ★ **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-confirmed by multiple sources). ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- ★ **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the state of war).
- ★ **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.

- ★ **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and Tr

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" (directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count above (19-20).
- ★ **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- ★ **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility.
- ★ **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- ★ **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a confirmed deal.
- ★ **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ **★ NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier *Almora* engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility; cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagged honestly as a research gap, not new information, and a reason this cycle is left as a draft rather than auto-stamped.
- ★ **★ NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker *Amara* was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iranian law and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE; the "escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- ★ **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- ★ **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to Congress but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which has not yet been unveiled.
- ★ **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- ★ **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- ★ **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- ★ **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- ★ **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- ★ **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile was not used alone to move P.
- ★ **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of the Aug 18 strike, describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.
- ★ **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- ★ **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the deadline, framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle the situation" with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM's tally (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the trend.
- ★ **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- ★ **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, not confirmed; responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) reported that Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand or deal.
- ★ **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- ★ **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, BBC).
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government report, and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- ★ **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact on the Strait.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent outlets) reported an announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) reported that the deal for the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."

★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait of Hormuz, saying the attack was "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying a full cargo of LNG, with a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg).
- ★ ★ **NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that could reshape the region's security architecture.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA). The deal requires UN or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and Shafaq News (Iranian state media).
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called the deal "a deal" and it recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed terms as "a deal."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle has been reached." (Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com).
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants a fee for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the lull.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org reported a US strike on an Iranian oil tanker (Iranian state media contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable).
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first meeting in Riyadh.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the cancellation. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump's "deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being negotiated.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an agreement on a 60-day interim deal and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization of a deal.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — both the base and CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, and Tikrit. "A violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia official).
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel).
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the rebound.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting Trump's framing. Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 68-32.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced report that one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, US Navy, and others.
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~Aug 16 remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~\$98,225 intraday low, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't started.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~\$34,300 intraday low, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~+25-28% by Mar 10. The Aug 30-Sept 2 direct US-Iran exchange escalated sharply (a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, a four-country Iranian retaliation), resetting the corridor claim is still technically on the table, unretracted, but has not been confirmed reopened either. As of this cycle (Sept 19), the picture is mixed rather than clearly escalating further: Iran's "deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks — a genuinely ambiguous signal, not a resumption of the Sept 1-2 intensity. BTC traded at **\$81,224.46** on Sept 19, up sharply from \$78,046.80 on Sept 18 — this pillar's own P held flat this cycle (Claim), not treated as pillar-scoring evidence — this report scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. The upside case is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty corridor to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium unwinds for real." Trump's planned Sept 22 UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders is the nearest dated event that could trigger a full corridor reopening.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude from the "under 8 points per window" mechanical cut, and just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the cut "under 8 points per window" mechanically, out of habit from s
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, b reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidentiary gap.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself said in advance this class of event was different in kind, not just degree.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign n action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a read
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange
- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by S infrastructure, and Trump's own account describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen. Neither moves P (one is purely diplomatic, the other single reader could argue that asymmetry itself biases the cut direction over time even when each individual scoring decision is defensible.

The Triggers

ated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. **As of Sept 19 (full weekly refresh):** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike is now CONFIRMED (reversing the Sept 18 NOT USED call, but not moving P — see [this](#)); process continues moving but remains unenacted (new row below); and the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional gridlock, a new row below. None of this clears the "Trend" could not be corroborated and was NOT USED — see the top rows. As of Sept 16, 2026: the IAEA's UNSC referral (Sept 9) and the 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal push (Sept 12-13) are the newest entries, driving this cycle's 6; on Iran proper, confirmed via on-record CENTCOM statements and 20+ independent outlets; escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM's first, but not executed; CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the IIRC retaliates for that strike by hitting Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces a third consecutive session above \$100 including a close above \$107 on Sept 10. **By Sept 11-12, Houthi forces completed their sweep of Yemen's Red Sea coastline and seized Bab al-Mandeb's Mayyun Island** — a second global escalation datapoint in six weeks landed: **Iran's foreign ministry announced Fri Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq will convene in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 on Strait of Hormuz (SOFH) outlets.** It drives this pillar's first UPWARD re-rate since Aug 6, sized small against Bahrain's announced non-attendance, an Iranian official's statement that no deal is expected, the fact that the agenda concerns **does NOT fire the upside flip line**, which requires a signed, US-accepted Hormuz reopening holding a full clean week. In the prior Sept 12 full weekly refresh, a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike landed — (remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires.

DATE	EVENT
Sept 17, reported Sept 17-18; UPCOMING Tuesday Sept 22 — dated, multi-sourced (Axios original, plus Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News — 5+ independent)	Trump told Axios he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime or not, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly vote on a resolution condemning Iran's nuclear program (Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman)
Struck Sept 17-18 — CONFIRMED via IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint) plus independent outlets (The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, Rio Times)	The IRGC struck the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18; crew reported safe, no confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmation
Sept 7-13, still unenacted as of Sept 19 — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anewsi, Militarnyi, IFP News)	Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging President Rouhani to withdraw from the NPT. Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done; a bill was submitted for expedited consideration but not yet voted on. "We are ready to accept any conditions," he said, "but we must be prepared"
Sept 18 — PRIMARY (UN press releases sc16455 and related) plus Euronews and Security Council Report's monthly forecast	The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing) to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposed Iranian sanctions Pakistan abstaining, deepening the ongoing Russia/China-vs-E3 legal dispute over the 2025 "snapback" sanctions reimposition
FIRE d Sept 9, reported Sept 12-16 — PRIMARY (IAEA Board of Governors institutional action)	The IAEA Board of Governors voted to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council, escalating international pressure over Iran's nuclear program. The board adopted a resolution demanding Iran suspend all enrichment activities by September 24, 2025. 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal, with a headline MP saying "the time has come." (The New York Times, Mehr News — 3 independent outlets). Counterweight: President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry said it would consider any proposal "with great interest." (Associated Press, Reuters, CNN, BBC, Al Jazeera, The Guardian, Washington Post, New York Times, Wall Street Journal, Financial Times, Bloomberg, CNBC, Fox Business, MSNBC, CBS, ABC, NBC, PBS, NPR, The National, National Herald, USA Today, Time Magazine, Newsweek, The Economist, The Independent, The Mirror, The Daily Mail, The Telegraph, The Sun, The Express, The Mail Online, Sky News, ITV, Channel 4, BBC One, BBC Two, BBC Three, BBC Four, BBC News, BBC Radio 4, BBC Radio 5 Live, BBC Radio 6 Music, BBC Radio 7, BBC Radio 8, BBC Radio 9, BBC Radio 10, BBC Radio 11, BBC Radio 12, BBC Radio 13, BBC Radio 14, BBC Radio 15, BBC Radio 16, BBC Radio 17, BBC Radio 18, BBC Radio 19, BBC Radio 20, BBC Radio 21, BBC Radio 22, BBC Radio 23, BBC Radio 24, BBC Radio 25, BBC Radio 26, BBC Radio 27, BBC Radio 28, BBC Radio 29, BBC Radio 30, BBC Radio 31, BBC Radio 32, BBC Radio 33, BBC Radio 34, BBC Radio 35, BBC Radio 36, BBC Radio 37, BBC Radio 38, BBC Radio 39, BBC Radio 40, BBC Radio 41, BBC Radio 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Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T ... after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After 1 News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and e any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed "in the coming days" (PR Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabl retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded; no Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the St
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned fa
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti- of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tan
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old it
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most pr
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it inter
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/in determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, T Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entr continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran itself sa compliance
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (U safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force su corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, R
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention "obstructing this process"
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime

Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false alarm"
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned ; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal ; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened)
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill)
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO ta
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full we
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper — **As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause fired** — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29. **As of Sept 11, the four clauses are now live;** the remaining two (a confirmed new US combat death, a widening to a further new state with confirmed attribution) are not. **As of Sept 1-2, the strikes clause was already firing again** — OTHER three clauses have independently fired fresh: the "confirmed new US combat death" clause remains unfired (no confirmed US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire; war, so "further new state with confirmed attribution" is not met; Brent rose ~5% (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6 but remains short of a sustained \$100 close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest single-outlet yet withheld — a 3-tanker retaliation for an ICGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — and Sept 6 brings further single-source ICGC claims of additional strikes. Neither independently re-fires any of the three, but the Sept 2 cycle, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority (sourcing is primary/multi-outlet, no call-band flip). **The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepted** — US-Iran naval exchange makes a durable, US-accepted deal considerably further away, not closer. Watch next cycle for: whether Sept 6's ICGC claims are independently confirmed, whether either side's threatened a \$100 — any of which would independently fire a fresh flip-line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. **UPDATE, Sept 8:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the Strait of Hormuz, yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state). **Sept 9:** CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second ICGC missile attack on a US Navy warship — a repeat pattern, not a new one. This cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but an intraday cross is explicitly not a sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle. The Sept 9 cycle is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war), whether the restricted zone is actually declared and enforced, whether the Iran-Oman corridor deal is actually signed, a confirmed US combat death, a repeat target and both sides confirm no casualties, so neither clause fires. Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on Bab el-Mandeb — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already present. Sept 9's intraday cross and the closest this cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle. The Sept 9 cycle is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war) — they hold Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline plus Mayyun (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (6+ independent outlets), and Brent has held a fifth straight session. US casualty is confirmed, so that clause doesn't fire either — this is a severity escalation within the already-fired sustained-Brent and direct-strikes clauses, not a fresh clause. The cut is moderate (no window move). The Sept 9 cycle is merely holding its shores/islands, whether Zuqar Island's contested status resolves, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. **UPDATE, Sept 12 (full weekly refresh):** a third cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle. The Sept 12 cycle is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war) — regardless of the move's size — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. Watch next cycle for: whether responsibility for the pipeline strike is claimed or independently confirmed. **UPDATE, Sept 19 (full weekly refresh):** none of the four clauses newly fires this cycle. Iran's parliament still has not enacted NPT withdrawal (proposal-stage only); Trump's Sept 17 "big decision" remark remains unacted. Sept 17 sanctions-panel renewal is institutional gridlock, not a new sanction or act of war; the "Trend" tanker strike (Sept 17-18) is newly confirmed but is a continuation of the already-priced tanker campaign. The Sept 19 cycle is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war) — AS DRAFT for Alex's manual review regardless of move size (here, none). Watch next cycle for: the outcome of the Sept 22 UN General Assembly Gulf-states meeting, whether the NPT-withdrawal bill is actually voted.

P (2026-09-19_draft, DRAFT — FULL WEEKLY refresh, awaiting Alex's manual review; HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 14 / 33 / 66 • Prior committed P (2026-09-19_draft, DRAFT — FULL WEEKLY refresh, awaiting Alex's manual review; HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 14 / 33 / 66 • Pillar's signals (all unchanged): 1mo -4.70 • 3mo -5.10 • 6mo -4.03 (Strong Bear) • 1yr -1.77 (Bear) • 3yr +1.41 (Mild Bull) • Master (equal-weight blend): -0.02 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.51 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull), moved slightly from the last cycle's -0.03/+0.50 on Fed & Macro's three qualitative pillar reports for their own independent Sept 19 full-weekly-refresh findings

Sept 18 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-18 draft), prior cycle: two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Axios, Breitbart, RedState, Western Journal, anews — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty. The Strait of Hormuz Sept 18; a follow-up targeted search could not independently corroborate this from any named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source — **treated as NOT FIRED / NOT USED**, the same as the daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 18, 2026** per the runbook's delegated authority. Tokenization RWA is the only pillar that moved this cycle — see that report for details.

Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15 draft), this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off: the Salalah ministerial never convened. **replacement date** — corroborated across Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attending, no GCC state had confirmed, and the UAE had downgraded its understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz." Brent pushed past \$107 (+2.8%) on the news — a market price, reported not scored. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (1mo -2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150, 151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200, 201, 202, 203, 204, 205, 206, 207, 208, 209, 210, 211, 212, 213, 214, 215, 216, 217, 218, 219, 220, 221, 222, 223, 224, 225, 226, 227, 228, 229, 230, 231, 232, 233, 234, 235, 236, 237, 238, 239, 240, 241, 242, 243, 244, 245, 246, 247, 248, 249, 250, 251, 252, 253, 254, 255, 256, 257, 258, 259, 260, 261, 262, 263, 264, 265, 266, 267, 268, 269, 270, 271, 272, 273, 274, 275, 276, 277, 278, 279, 280, 281, 282, 283, 284, 285, 286, 287, 288, 289, 290, 291, 292, 293, 294, 295, 296, 297, 298, 299, 300, 301, 302, 303, 304, 305, 306, 307, 308, 309, 310, 311, 312, 313, 314, 315, 316, 317, 318, 319, 320, 321, 322, 323, 324, 325, 326, 327, 328, 329, 330, 331, 332, 333, 334, 335, 336, 337, 338, 339, 340, 341, 342, 343, 344, 345, 346, 347, 348, 349, 350, 351, 352, 353, 354, 355, 356, 357, 358, 359, 360, 361, 362, 363, 364, 365, 366, 367, 368, 369, 370, 371, 372, 373, 374, 375, 376, 377, 378, 379, 380, 381, 382, 383, 384, 385, 386, 387, 388, 389, 390, 391, 392, 393, 394, 395, 396, 397, 398, 399, 400, 401, 402, 403, 404, 405, 406, 407, 408, 409, 410, 411, 412, 413, 414, 415, 416, 417, 418, 419, 420, 421, 422, 423, 424, 425, 426, 427, 428, 429, 430, 431, 432, 433, 434, 435, 436, 437, 438, 439, 440, 441, 442, 443, 444, 445, 446, 447, 448, 449, 450, 451, 452, 453, 454, 455, 456, 457, 458, 459, 460, 461, 462, 463, 464, 465, 466, 467, 468, 469, 470, 471, 472, 473, 474, 475, 476, 477, 478, 479, 480, 481, 482, 483, 484, 485, 486, 487, 488, 489, 490, 491, 492, 493, 494, 495, 496, 497, 498, 499, 500, 501, 502, 503, 504, 505, 506, 507, 508, 509, 510, 511, 512, 513, 514, 515, 516, 517, 518, 519, 520, 521, 522, 523, 524, 525, 526, 527, 528, 529, 530, 531, 532, 533, 534, 535, 536, 537, 538, 539, 540, 541, 542, 543, 544, 545, 546, 547, 548, 549, 550, 551, 552, 553, 554, 555, 556, 557, 558, 559, 560, 561, 562, 563, 564, 565, 566, 567, 568, 569, 570, 571, 572, 573, 574, 575, 576, 577, 578, 579, 580, 581, 582, 583, 584, 585, 586, 587, 588, 589, 590, 591, 592, 593, 594, 595, 596, 597, 598, 599, 600, 601, 602, 603, 604, 605, 606, 607, 608, 609, 610, 611, 612, 613, 614, 615, 616, 617, 618, 619, 620, 621, 622, 623, 624, 625, 626, 627, 628, 629, 630, 631, 632, 633, 634, 635, 636, 637, 638, 639, 640, 641, 642, 643, 644, 645, 646, 647, 648, 649, 650, 651, 652, 653, 654, 655, 656, 657, 658, 659, 660, 661, 662, 663, 664, 665, 666, 667, 668, 669, 670, 671, 672, 673, 674, 675, 676, 677, 678, 679, 680, 681, 682, 683, 684, 685, 686, 687, 688, 689, 690, 691, 692, 693, 694, 695, 696, 697, 698, 699, 700, 701, 702, 703, 704, 705, 706, 707, 708, 709, 710, 711, 712, 713, 714, 715, 716, 717, 718, 719, 720, 721, 722, 723, 724, 725, 726, 727, 728, 729, 730, 731, 732, 733, 734, 735, 736, 737, 738, 739, 740, 741, 742, 743, 744, 745, 746, 747, 748, 749, 750, 751, 752, 753, 754, 755, 756, 757, 758, 759, 760, 761, 762, 763, 764, 765, 766, 767, 768, 769, 770, 771, 772, 773, 774, 775, 776, 777, 778, 779, 780, 781, 782, 783, 784, 785, 786, 787, 788, 789, 790, 791, 792, 793, 794, 795, 796, 797, 798, 799, 800, 801, 802, 803, 804, 805, 806, 807, 80

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars in independent re-check (see those reports). Iran War Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass** logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina were struck, causing injuries and material damage, at OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. Dublin, called Iran "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED remark, logged as exactly that, not as fact. **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty this cycle). The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE) urging "maximum restraint" — a mild, long News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/11/18/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-flt stamp authority regardless of move size or how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own **"sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED**. Brent ended the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the close than the prior cycle. **Went to the next line.** The **US-UK oil tanker attack** was a miss and explicitly flagged it for watching, and the honest reading now is that it fired. *Correction to the prior cycle:* the Sept 10 run logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close. **US-UK oil tanker attack** with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire. **US-UK oil tanker attack** transits Sept 9 vs a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13/day. Logged as counterweight: Friday's give-back is attributed to Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED D** **US-UK oil tanker attack** research access was full (WebSearch/WebFetch working, local quant refresh ran), and verification passed clean — and under the runbook's widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the cycle. **US-UK oil tanker attack** Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check; Fed & Macro re-rated up modestly after the August CPI print landed mid-cycle with core a tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRCG Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms U.S. after the IRCG targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in a confirmed-US-vocalized flip-line clause remains unfired — and Gulf of Oman/Kharg Island are both existing theater, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause does not fire either; this is a repeat pattern, not a U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — a genuine escalation data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but a single-day intraday remains in the same not-yet-executed state as the Sept 8 baseline logged it — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified, so it is not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation and intensification of the Sept 8 baseline. **7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band closed at 72. **72 stamped).**"

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Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night roughly flat (~\$95.2-95.75 Sept 4), still short of \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts who concluded the Sept 1 K was single-narrative to independently corroborated by a primary Western wire service, but the US has still not accepted responsibility (VP Vance: “extremely skeptical,” Sept 4, calling it under investigation), and (developing): Iranian state/semi-official media (Fars) reported four missiles struck an Iranian oil tanker near Kharg Island, Iran’s primary oil-export terminal — no CENTCOM or independent Western multi-sensor would be a materially new escalation vector (a direct hit on Iran’s core oil-export infrastructure, distinct from the Sept 1-2 tanker-hull strikes). Also noted: Iran reportedly warned the US that an Israeli move pending trigger, not a fired one. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. CORRECTION:** this cycle’s commit message claimed “AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026,” but config/scores.json’s status field was never

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact** — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported “tanker for tanker” policy. A US strike on Kheystak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a warship. This is the first time a US strike has been explicitly flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, so it is NOT itself used to move P. It is reported as context for Iran’s response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US ships. Corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI, Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not a combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a further, larger cut.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-baïd flip and the size of a move are no longer relevant. The research was multi-sourced, and the single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. Nothing about the underlying facts, sourcing, or the

What Changed Since Last Check

- Not independently re-researched this cycle — this was a targeted single-pillar Fed & Macro follow-up (two regional Fed survey findings; see that pillar's report for the sourcing), not a fresh Iraq
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Not re-researched this cycle (targeted single-pillar touch) — carried forward from the Sept 19 weekly review. AUTO-STAMPED alongside Fed &

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 19, 2026 (score set **2026-09-19 draft**, DRAFT — awaiting Alex's manual review) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-18 draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66), via a full independent prim

- Carried forward — what changed in the September 18 light daily touch (2026-09-18_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:*

- **Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime**, ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Axios 9/17/2022). The decision is not a foregone conclusion, but it is a high-stakes one. The US has an undated future decision; near-term windows already price maximal active-war uncertainty (1mo/3mo $P=1$), so it does not clear the bar for a further move.

- **Checked and NOT USED** — a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz Sept 18. An initial general search surfaced the claim; a follow-up report's house discipline for unconfirmed single claims — no P move on it either way.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set **2026-09-17_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-16_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Re-checked for a new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT-withdrawal statement — found none.** Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons statement found on the Salalah ministerial, the Saudi pipeline repair timeline, or Hormuz shipping.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 16 light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 16, 2026 (score set **2026-09-16_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12/18/38/70.**

- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council** — a primary institutional escalation not previously priced by this pillar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal**, with a hardline MP saying an emergency session would be called.
- **Counterweight, logged:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared" — a real step, not a bluff.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, 1/1/18/38/70 → 1/1/14/33/66.** 1mo/3mo held at the floor (no room to move further); 6mo 18→14, 12mo 38→33, 36mo 70→66.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft, committed, auto-stamped, held flat), for continuity:

- **The Salalah ministerial remains postponed with no new date** — the fact that drove yesterday's re-rate down, unchanged. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds detail already consistent with what was reported: "The ministerial is postponed until a date and no reason beyond 'in the interests of consensus.'"
- **Saudi Arabia's East-West (Petroline) pipeline is still offline** — already priced Sept 12. Saudi energy-ministry sources put the loss at roughly **700,000 barrels a day**; Aramco has not said how long it will be offline. **Energy — reported, not scored.**
- **INTERESTED-PARTY CLAIM, reported not scored:** Bloomberg (Sept 14) reports an *Iranian claim* that a tanker struck mines in the Strait of Hormuz. Uncorroborated by any independent party or datapoint, also single-sourced and not scored.
- **MARKET PRICES, reported not scored:** Brent closed above **\$105** and WTI rose toward **\$102** (Sept 14–15), slightly below yesterday's ~\$108 Brent print. Still inside the already-fired "sustained US-strikes clause is unfired."
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ ★ **NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone the ministerial independently by Arab News, the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact yesterday's upward re-rate was built on, and it did not survive the week."
- **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already announced**.
- **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman characterizing the delay as "determined to promote dialogue that contributes to stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian state media). **Technical work is real:** navigational charts drawn, draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement — which is why the 1-year window held one point above zero.
- **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored:** Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponement.
- **Checked and REJECTED as stale:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated **March 2026**.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC realignment framework) · 36mo flat (nothing structural moved). Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated authority.

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ ★ **NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iran's neighbors** will meet in Oman to discuss "the need for a comprehensive framework for regional security"; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARM).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the Houthis; mosque; Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13).
- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributable to the postponement.
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and count against the move, not that.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the move is most likely to occur. **(auto-stamped)** — an ordinary light daily touch with full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the sufficiency bar. The direction of the move is not itself a reason to stamp.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ ★ **NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone strikes** (Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both counterweighting the move.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL WEEKLY stamp** authority regardless of move size).

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad by the Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Materially counterweighting the move.
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).

- ★ **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,** temporarily halted; Saudi authorities confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera, The Daily Caller, SRN News, plus the Saudi Energy Ministry).
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy Intelligence).
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (Sept 11, single-source, not used to move P).
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3 moved more than 4 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces repeat target — the widening clause does not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire either.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line).
- ★ **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained cross.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100); master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island)** (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship"). Both Iranian carriers were confirmed.
- ★ **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle had come.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any US warship that enters.** In addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- ★ **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100); master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority:** status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an IRGC strike on an American personnel harmed.**
- ★ **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — not used to move P.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets.** A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause was not used.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island.** Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (independent) denies it (an accusation, not a confirmed fact); CENTCOM has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P per the sufficiency rule — WATCH NEXT CYCLE.
- ★ **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolved.
- ★ **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100); master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.
- ★ **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW** — **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike.** IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms.
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms),** under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact** — **a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. bride).
- ★ ★ **NEW** — **Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait.** All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire the widening clause.
- ★ **NEW** — **Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump's tweet).
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75) — 1mo -6, 3mo -6, 6mo -5, 12mo -3, 36mo -1; front-loaded, kept under the 8-point threshold, but this was a genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening larger future action, and the master call band flip Mild Bull → Neutral); **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles (Aug 25).
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion.** (The Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International).
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- ★ **Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports)** — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a repeat target.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1)** — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).

- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line delegated daily authority: light daily touch, no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged vs. the last stamped set (Mild Bull → Mild Bull), sourcing well above the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two Iranian targets, ending a 30-night clean streak. **Fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted; confirmed US casualty from either event.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. AUG 31, 2026

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry.** ~60 entities/individuals named, including state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts. **For the first time, digital assets was named a sanctionable sector — 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, practical, Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: every prior draft had a project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor. Still "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance. No fee terms disclosed.
- **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents, Aug 24** (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew rescued).
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began.
- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- **NEW — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined,** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 report of a mine.
- **NEW — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week.
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed; the proposed deal this pillar's flip line requires.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim. Treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered/render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes, cutting P to 14/22/38/54/76 and delivering it as a draft.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel episode").
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treated as not-delivered.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) framed the strike as a "novel episode".
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel episode" framing was dropped.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (19-20 dead) against the toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing the Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. 50 the prior week).
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran says no strikes.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a score change.
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; **HOLD** **23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded September 19, 2026, FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-19_draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then secondary sources; no primary-source access degradation, though WebFetch to arbitrary domains.

- **September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (this cycle):** Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Military, IFP News (Sept 7-13) — NPT-withdrawal process: 130-lawmaker statement, Parliament Presidium speech (Sept 13) · Axios (Sept 17, primary original interview), Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News (Sept 17-18) — Trump's "big decision"/"annihilate" remark and the forecast (Sept 18) — the 11-2-2 Security Council vote (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) failing to renew the Iran-sanctions monitoring panel · IRNA (primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint), The Hill, CNN, denial · CNBC, Al Jazeera (Sept 18) — Brent ~\$103.21/bbl, market price · GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker (nine clean days vs. a "host state") and Times of Israel liveblog (Sept 19, Houthi-linked air-raid alert, Iran says no strikes, reopen Hormuz (net wash).
- **September 18 light daily touch (prior cycle):** Axios — original interview, Trump's "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Sept 17, primary reporting of a direct quote) · Times of Israel, Politico Wire (Sept 18, Iran state leaders) · general web search, targeted follow-up for corroboration of a claimed IRGC strike on a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz, Sept 18 — no named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC).
- **September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch: Oman News Agency (ONA) — state news agency statement, Sunday Sept 13, 2026: the Salalah regional meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions for a meeting"** "Oman says Hormuz talks with Iran, Gulf states postponed" (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, "Oman postpones regional talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 13) · CNN, "Iran-Gulf talks without US participation on reopening the Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 13) · source for Iran's MFA spokesman attributing the delay to a Saudi request — *single-party-sourced, reported not scored* — and for Brent \$107.54 / WTI \$102.34, *market prices* · Malay Mail, "Oman postpones Iran-Gulf talks" (Sept 13) · primary for Iran's stated position, not for facts it asserts about others · Eurasia Review and Sunday Guardian (Sept 14) — corroborating the Araqchi statement · *Checked and excluded as stale:* Seatrade Maritime, Argus Media.
- **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss the Strait of Hormuz with Gulf states on Monday, "Sept 11 · Dawn, "Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz future," Sept 12 · Arab News · Oman Observer, "Salalah to host Iran-GCC Hormuz talks" (Sept 12) · (safe/temporary shipping routes, mine clearance, short-term management of the waterway) · Bahrain's Sept 12 announcement that it will not participate — logged counterweight · Jerusalem Post, "No signed Hormuz deal yet" (Sept 12) · killed, 4 wounded; Iran's attribution to the US logged as Iran's own, not established), Houthi projectile on Jazan, continued Bab al-Mandeb fighting · TradingEconomics and Forbes — Brent's 4.24% Friday Sept 11 give-back.
- **September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (prior cycle):** Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Petroline) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, Sept 11 · and Al Dhokra · Iraqi PM's office (via corroborating outlets) — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shalamchah border crossing closed · President Trump's on-record Zuhri remarks — Iran says no strikes, joint declaration, Sept 12, signed by all members plus Saudi Arabia, Iran, and UAE, urging "exercising maximum restraint" · Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge — re-verification.

- **September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning):** Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC, NBS's request for US strikes on the Houthis refused · UKMTO Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two vessels near Khasab, Oman, one afire · Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill — co War 2026 Day 196 (Sept 11) — IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike near the Strait entrance, no US confirmation found · local run.py quant refresh — BTC \$76,745.60 (Sept 13) vs. \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11)
- **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102, contraction forecast as the counterweight · Vantage Markets, NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strike risk · Reuters wire via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attack Day 195 (Sept 10) — direct fetch returned HTTP 403 this cycle, so its content is cited only as surfaced in search summaries (flagged as a degraded pull, not used alone to move P).
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles Post, Cyprus Mail — corroborating reporting on the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait · CNBC — Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, first time since aggregator's claim of a fresh KIA figure checked and rejected as uncorroborated · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$77,993.99 (Sept 10) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8).
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charmarin, M/T H the two IRGC missile attempts on a US Navy warship, both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries" (Sept 9) · ABC News — corroborating Brent ~\$100.44 intraday, vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's Strait of Hormuz?," Sept 7 explainer, noting boundaries not yet announced, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same Rezaei statement · (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 close · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6)
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships · Al Jazeera live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sept 6) and Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian forces targeting a US naval drone) — Ir multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 6, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
- **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed independent weapons experts' forensic analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuestak wedding strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments); VP Vance's CENTCOM or any independent source · Critical Threats/ISW — Iran's warning that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; IDF took the ridge Sept 3, no such attack confirmed
- **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strike on government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuestak, Hormozgan wedding-strike casualty claim (Hormozgan governor's office source, Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL — corroborating reporting on Iran's IRGC Sept 2 coordinated strikes on Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait, interception rates, and the absence of a confirmed new US combat death · CBS (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6, WTI ~\$91-92 · Bitstamp — BTC \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) vs. \$78,038.78 (Sept 1).
- **September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, engine room, Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran's army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an intercepted Iranian drone over UAE territorial waters · CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — Brent ~+2% Tuesday Sept 1 on fresh-clash fears · Bitstamp — BTC \$78,038.78 (Sept 1) vs. \$78,447.16 (Aug 31).
- **August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting:** CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/NBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 30 strike on Iran's IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases, Jordan (Aug 31) · Jordan's military statement (via Fox News, HNGN) — 8 missiles intercepted · Al Jazeera — "Iran targets Jordan after 1
- **August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches:** home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and 30 BTC/ETH/TRON addresses listed, first-ever digital-assets sectoral designation) · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov.om/en/53722 — Oman's own Foreign Ministry joint statement, Aug 25, confirmed
- **August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data:** UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade briefing Intelligence — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick, +30%+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (Aug 26) — IRGC spokesman's Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry · TradingEconomics, various consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton confirmed killed Jul 18-19, already in the standing total, not a new Aug 22
- **August 28 light daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft) — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; treated as abandoned/superseded, findings independently re-verified fresh above:** UKMTO-sourced crew safe, "second attack this week" · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal statement describes only an "interim framework" · TradingEconomics, Easternherald — Brent ~\$87.65-89/bbl (Aug 27), easing from the Aug 20-21 range.
- **August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below):** Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative across 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike, 6 killed per Al Jazeera) — NET FINDING: honest range 15-19 EgyptToday (all Aug 19) — UAE missile-attack and trade-embargo reporting, initially flagged as a possible second incident, reconciled on cross-reference to the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN ~\$93-95/bbl, second straight weekly gain (~6%), highest since late July).
- **August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below):** Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own initial News separately reports three seafarers killed in a June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets (see draft2 entry above for this cycle's further re-verification, which settles barrage hit UAE Apr 1-8 (ceasefire Apr 8) and again at Fujairah Petroleum Industries Zone May 4 (3 wounded, oil-loading disrupted), both predating and contradicting the "novel escalation vector" framing carried since Aug 18)
- **August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes):** UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck, near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's toll regime, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down · home.treasury.gov / Bessent public statement found · TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune (Aug 21) — Brent ~\$93-95/bbl · Iranian state media (Aug 22) — Iran will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71
- **August 18-20 verification:** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a possible commercial vessel struck by unknown projectile in the Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new source) — Brent ~\$92/bbl · Financial Times, citing unnamed Iranian officials — claim that Iran assessed potential strikes on US assets in Europe (Bulgaria airbase, Cyprus, fiber cables). Single-source, uncorroborated by any second source
- **August 17-18 draft sources (never delivered as a report; independently re-verified this cycle against the above and found accurate):** CBS News — live desk, "Trump threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stuck in" baseline re-checked this cycle to ~110/day, not the ~130/day originally carried; Brent \$90.87) · CNN — "Deadline to reach US-Iran deal expires, Trump threatens Oman" (Aug 17) · Al Jazeera — live blog, MoU expiry coverage
- **August 16 light daily check:** Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO). Vance remarks on energy-fuels despite continued shipping attacks.
- **August 14 light daily check:** US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman deal of Hormuz threaten to derail reopening" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — all confirm the same stalled-on-compensation dispute, hardened not resolved; a live
- **August 13 light daily check:** CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US"
- **August 11 light daily check:** NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement
- **August 10 light daily check:** GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia
- **August 9 light daily check:** Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rappler (Aug 8)
- **August 8 full-weekly additions:** Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-brokered Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact (Aug 7) · Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by deal: What do they all want?" (Aug 5) · Bloomberg — "Iran-Oman Deal Proposes Ban on US, Israeli Ships in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 6) · CNBC — US official rejects one-sided fee/ban terms (Aug 6).
- **August 7 additions:** Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Shipping coverage, Iran's IRGC commander reiterates nuclear-development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile.
- **August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 6) "close" to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran and Oman agree route for ships" (Aug 5) · Fortune — "Iran says it has Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" · Forbes — "Hormuz Is Becoming A Fee-And-Permission Regime" (background, Jul 28) · Fast Company / DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 5
- **August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** globalsecurity.org — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels planned joint US-Israeli strike, "perimeters of a deal" (Aug 4) · iranistrep.com — bulkier strike — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday (Aug 5).
- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan (Jul 28-29), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed, corroborated by CNN, Fortune — Brent ~\$92-93 (Jul 30) · CNN — Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks (Jul 27).
- **July 11-13 additions (prior full refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack round, Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador summoned · Naharnet and Iran International — Iran/Oman/Qatar median-lane deal (Jul 11) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · Kaieteur News — Iranian Health Ministry casualty figures (17 killed / 115 wounded, unverified government claim) · CryptoTimes, CoinDesk, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinga
- **July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (refined)

- The escalation (**official statements via wire reporting**): NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited v states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Iran's nuclear program (July 8)
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 10; magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source) · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9)
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct Polymarket — Iran normalizes relations by July 10 (July 10; recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads ~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.